SD-23

Department of Defense Item Reduction Program Guidebook



DEFENSE STANDARDIZATION PROGRAM OFFICE

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SDMP

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Foreword

Parts and Material Management Program processes improve parts selection by requiring a systems engineering approach for parts management planning. As an integral part of the Parts and Material Management Program, the Item Reduction (IR) program effectively increases part standardization and finds preferred parts in the supply system.

This Department of Defense Item Reduction Guidebook contains the procedures for sorting items of supply by name modifier or other characteristics, such as size, grade, length, and material. This sorting separates items in the supply system, classified as preferred and retained for stock, from items not to be acquired for continued supply. The Item Reduction Website Capability (IRWSC) is the primary tool for coordination and distribution of IR decisions and is maintained in that capacity. The IRWSC is currently under review and may transition to a new application in the future.

A comprehensive parts and material management program helps to find preferred parts, increasing supportability and safety of systems and equipment and reducing total ownership costs. Using preferred parts reduces risk and improves system reliability, thereby reducing maintenance actions and failures that could cause mission failure or loss of life. Item reduction as a part of the Parts and Material Management Program supports our warfighters.

If you have any questions or comments about this document or the Item Reduction Program, please contact the Defense Standardization Program Office, Attn: J-307, 8725 John J. Kingman Road, Stop 6233, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-6221, or email DSPO@dla.mil.

Michael Heaphy
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Background

The Department of Defense (DoD) Item Reduction (IR) Program reduces the number of items similar in form, fit, and function from the Federal Supply System. The program's mission is to standardize the items throughout DoD to the highest practical degree by using single specifications and standards. During design, DoD programs have a system and program focus. Item reduction reviews the items in the federal catalog, increasing visibility of items across programs, military services, and federal agencies.

By reviewing and increasing the standardization of items in the federal catalog, item reduction offers many benefits:

- Economies of scale in acquisition. Increased demand resulting from a standardized item of supply can grow competition from suppliers, lower costs, and shorten acquisition lead times.
- Efficiencies in storage and distribution. Reduction in items of supply can lessen storage and distribution requirements at all levels of storage from shipboard to major depot, shrinking the logistic footprint.
- Increased reliability. Increased item standardization leads to a more extensive performance history and user experience that can improve part selection.

The IR Program uses IR studies to do the following:

- Identify items for elimination from the supply system.
- Coordinate proposed item relationships (interchangeable or substitutable items) with the military and federal users of the items to ensure satisfaction of all technical requirements.
- Eliminate non-standard items from the Federal Logistics Information System (FLIS), updating the Federal Catalog System (FCS).

IR activities initiate and coordinate IR studies through the Item Reduction Website Capability (IRWSC). See the IRWSC users' guide at https://www.dsp.dla.mil/Programs/Item-Reduction/.

SUCCESS STORY—NAVSEA IR APPROACH FOR FASTENERS

Naval Sea Systems Command (NAVSEA) formed a commonality team for a deep dive on fasteners to eliminate redundant and dormant fastener national stock numbers (NSNs) from the supply system. The team targeted Navy-only fasteners for a quick win.

The team. The team included the technical warrant holder, in-service engineering agent, shipbuilders, and program offices.

The rules. NSNs were classified as duplicates if they had matches across all available characteristics. NSNs were dormant if 1) they had no procurements in the last 10 years, 2) they were not listed on any configuration in the fleet, and 3) they had no maintenance actions in the last 10 years.

The team coordinated with the NAVSEA reprocurement execution coordinator on any additional considerations, resulting in the addition of three exclusion factors: 1) NSNs created in the last 10 years, 2) nuclear items, and 3) North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) and non-DoD-owned NSNs.

Defense Logistics Agency (**DLA) assistance**. The team enlisted DLA Logistics Information Services (DLIS) to remove 41,731 Navy-only dormant NSNs from the catalog. DLA verified that no procurements or other requirements precluded eliminating these NSNs.

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1. PROCEDURES FOR IR CODING

1.1. Item Standardization Code Assignments

All NSNs in the FLIS total item record (TIR) are assigned an item standardization code (ISC). The standardization data of the TIR shows where and when the authorization decision was made. ISC assignments document standardization decisions in four areas. The four areas and the activities responsible for assignment of ISCs follow. See 1.2.1 and 1.2.2 for ISC definitions.

1.1.1. IR Studies

The Item Reduction Activity (IRA) proposes ISCs and, after coordination, submits the official ISCs to the DLIS. ISCs 1 and 3 apply. The IRA may also apply ISCs 2 or C to items included in IR studies as appropriate.

1.1.2. Superseding Specifications and Standards

The IRA implements and submits ISCs resulting from new, revised, or superseding specifications and standards. The preparing activity for the specification or standard must furnish any supplemental information required for proper assignment of ISCs to the IRA. ISCs B and E apply.

1.1.3. Determination That There Is No IR Potential in Federal Supply Class (FSC) or Item Name Grouping in the Class

The IRA assigns ISCs in this category. ISC 6 applies. The FSCs or item name codes previously recorded as ISC 6 should be reviewed periodically for standardization potential.

1.1.4. New NSN Requests

The DLIS assigns codes 5 or 0 automatically, as applicable, for new NSN requests and to maintain file integrity.

1.2. ISCs, Definitions, and Applications

The IRA assigns ISCs to items in accordance with the definitions and usage in this guidebook. The coding structure categorizes items as either “authorized for acquisition” or “not authorized for acquisition.” In these two broad categories, the specific codes indicate key management information about the decision process for assigning the ISC, the basis for assignment of the code, or a condition requiring further management attention.

1.2.1. Items Authorized for Acquisition

1.2.1.1. ISC 0. An item under the specification control of the Defense Threat Reduction Agency (DTRA) or the National Security Agency (NSA).

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1.2.1.2. ISC 1. An item authorized for acquisition, initially classified as the result of a formal IR study, and accepted as a replacement for one or more items not authorized for acquisition (ISC 3). In addition, ISC 1 is applied to generic NSNs. Generic relationships exist between the NSNs procured under defense or federal specifications, non-government standards (NGSs), or commercial item descriptions (CIDs) but the physical generic item is stocked, stored, and issued under NSNs assigned to ISC 2 for supply management. The NSNs for the defense or federal specifications, NGSs, or CIDs are coded ISC 1, and the acquisition advice code must be "W."

1.2.1.3. ISC 2. An item authorized for acquisition that has been included in an IR study for which no replacement item has been identified. In addition, for generic relationships, an ISC 2 is related to an ISC 1 item.

1.2.1.4. ISC 5. An item authorized for acquisition that has not been subjected to item standardization.

1.2.1.5. ISC 6. An item authorized for acquisition that is in a specific FSC or approved item name code for one-of-a-kind items with little or no potential for elimination through IR studies.

1.2.1.6. ISC B. An item authorized for acquisition in a new or revised superseding specification or standard that replaces one or more items not authorized for acquisition (ISC E) and may replace other ISC 3 items.

1.2.1.7. ISC C. An item authorized for acquisition that has been included in an IR study but a technical decision could not be made due to lack of sufficient data.

1.2.2. Items Not Authorized for Acquisition

1.2.2.1. ISC 3. An item, which, as a result of an IR study, is accepted as not authorized for acquisition and must have a replacement (ISC 1 or B).

1.2.2.2. ISC E. An item classified in a specification or standard as no longer authorized for acquisition and has been replaced by an item in a new or revised superseding specification or standard.

2. IR STUDIES

2.1. Responsibility for IR

The SD-1 Standardization Directory in ASSIST (https://assist.dla.mil) lists the activities responsible for performing IR studies. Once logged in, go to "DOD Contacts," then select search DoD contact by "FSC Assignment" from the DoD Contacts (SD-1) menu. Alternatively, once in ASSIST, search for SD-1, open the PDF view of SD-1 and go to Part 2, the Federal Supply Group and Class Assignment section. The DLIS accepts standardization data from the responsible IRA listed in SD-1 only. If an individual FSC has no IRA, the DLIS rejects all standardization data in that FSC.

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2.2. Required IR Studies

IR studies are applicable when many generally similar items lend themselves to grouping and examination by item names, item name modifiers, or other characteristics such as sizes, grades, lengths, and materials. IR sorts items of supply to separate items in the supply system for retainment of stock or direct delivery from the items not to be acquired for continued supply. Technical or engineering elements furnish the essential interchangeability and substitutability (I&S) criteria for applying ISCs to items in an IR study.

2.3. Limitation on Performing IR Studies

The IRA must evaluate the IR potential for a specific item name or grouping before performing a full-scale study. The IRA performs an IR study only when the expected benefits outweigh the costs of the study.

2.4. Planning and Programming IR Studies

IR studies are planned and programed in accordance with the following:

2.4.1. Lead Standardization Activity (LSA) Responsibility. The LSA ensures scheduling of proposed IR studies.

2.4.2. Scheduling IR Studies. The IRA schedules an IR study by requesting a standardization project assignment from the LSA and initiating a project via the ASSIST-Project.

2.5. IR Procedures

The IR study procedure is applicable to all items in an FSC or a specific category. The IRA may modify this procedure to maximize use of automated processes and accommodate the type of items under consideration.

2.5.1. Collecting Required Data. The IRA must have sufficient data to support the decision of the proposed ISC assigned to the item. The IRA must avoid requesting already available information or information that can be furnished from a central source.

2.5.2. Types of Data Required. The data in an IR study must encompass sufficient information for users to evaluate relationships. The following non-exhaustive list contains data typically required for an IR study:

- Technical drawings, standardization documents, purchase descriptions, comprehensive telephone and email conversation records, and other technical data.
- Special application data (submitted in justification of variations).
- Industry data (such as catalogs and cross-reference lists).
- I&S data.
- Cost and other non-technical data for categorizing the ISC.
- FLIS TIR data.

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2.5.3. Applicable NSNs. Normally, only items in the supply system with recorded U.S. users in the FLIS TIR are included in the IR study. However, other items (excluding NATO-only items) may be included at the IRA's discretion.

2.5.4. Grouping Items for Evaluation. The data for the items may be grouped by item name or noun and modifiers, user information, specification data (grouped by type, grade, class, and size for each specification), and other applicable factors such as physical and functional characteristics, criticality in end use, and special applications. Proper sequencing helps in the comparison of items, in the evaluation of whether those items are no longer needed, and the classification of the following:

2.5.4.1. Potential duplicates, physically and functionally interchangeable, but bearing different NSNs. Exact catalog duplicates should be processed in catalog channels for cancellations and not included in the IR study proposals.

2.5.4.2. Obsolete items. Obsolete items should be processed in cataloging channels for appropriate cancellation and not included in the proposed item reduction study listing (PIRSL).

2.5.4.3. Incomplete or inadequate item identification (further data required).

2.5.4.4. Items that are duplicates except for the method of dimensioning (for example, inches versus millimeters).

2.5.4.5. Items with insufficient specification and standard coverage.

2.5.4.6. Commercial items.

2.5.4.7. The need for an engineering practice study of some item name groups.

2.5.4.8. The need for obtaining NSNs for some items entering the supply system or representing modifications of items.

2.5.4.9. I&S relationships. These relationships must be between items of the same kind and with different item standardization codes and must be recorded for further use where applicable.

2.5.4.10. Government part numbers referenced to defense specifications or standards. These part numbers may be used by the IRA in the selection, coordination, and processing of PIRSLs. NSNs are assigned after full coordination of the IR study proposal.

2.5.5. Extraction of Data from the Item Identification Guide (IIG). To prepare the initial grouping of items in the study, the IRA may extract data from the IIG, as appropriate. The IRA may vary the sequence of data from that in the IIG, if it does not alter the concept of the item of supply, as expressed by the IIG. Where required, the applicable Item Identification Guide (https://www.dla.mil/What-DLA-Offers/Federal-and-International-Cataloging/IIG/) may be recommended for suitable modification.

2.5.6. Evaluation Criteria. The evaluation of items requires the selection of technical criteria essential for selecting the ISC for the items in each group or category, such as cost and other non-technical criteria. The technical criteria must be based on available specifications,

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standards, and other applicable source documents. The technical criteria should be the minimum required to differentiate between the items with respect to physical and functional interchangeability, end-use application, and design. Lifecycle and item costs are considered as part of the evaluation criteria as well as the I&S designation of the item. The coordination procedure must supply any additional technical input required to meet all needs.

2.5.7. Determining the ISC. The IRA compares the items of the basic groupings against the technical criteria, and then designates an appropriate ISC for each item. Replacement items (ISC 1 or B) are shown with all associated items designated as not authorized for acquisition (ISC 3 or E). One replacement item (ISC 1 or B) is established for each replaced item (ISC 3 or E). However, a single item can replace more than one item.

2.5.8. Multiple Replacement Standardization Relationships. Establishing multiple replacement standardization relationships is prohibited. Multiple replacement relationships assign two or more items an assigned ISC 1 or B to replace an item not authorized for acquisition (ISC 3 or E).

2.5.9. Generic Standardization Relationships. Generic standardization relationships provide supply management control of interchangeable items. These relationships are restricted to reparable items acquired under standardization documents listed in the ASSIST database. Separate NSNs classify the reparable items due to their internal configuration differences. The configuration differences require the availability of different repair parts at military repair facilities. Separate NSNs provide the necessary control to enable the return of contractor-repaired items to the appropriate contractor. The generic master NSN consolidates requirements and is for acquisition purposes only. Assets are stored under the “stock as” NSNs assigned to each interchangeable item. The generic master NSN must have acquisition advice code “W” and be an ISC 1. The interchangeable items of supply related to the generic master NSN are linked with a phrase code S (stock as), have recorded assets, and are the NSNs used for requisitioning. The “stock as” NSNs are ISC 2, fully interchangeable, interlinked with phrase code J, and indicate the generic master NSN with a phrase code 3. ISC 2 items may replace other ISC 3 items of older configuration or with less capabilities that are no longer procured.

2.6. Content of Proposed IR Study Listings

2.6.1. The IRWSC must contain the following information for the subject study:

- Project number.
- FSC.
- Project title.
- Item names in the study.
- IRA.
- Custodians. For items used by civilian agencies, the custodian is the General Services Administration (GSA).
- The listing contains proposed ISC 3 items and their replacement code 1 or B items only.
- Index number.

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- Item names and modifiers.
- National Item Identification Number.
- Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE).
- Reference.
- Proposed ISC.
- Users code, the primary control activity (PICA) or the secondary inventory control activity (SICA) according to the major organizational (MOE) rules in the FLIS TIR. See DoDM 4100.39, Volume 13, Chapter 6, https://www.dla.mil/HQ/LogisticsOperations/TrainingandReference/FLISProcedures.aspx.
- Remarks.

2.6.2. Sequencing

The listing order is chosen based on what is most advantageous for the commodity covered. However, a proposed ISC 1 or B item that replaces ISC 3 items must immediately precede the replaced items.

2.6.2.1. Items proposed for ISC 3 have the same index number as the replacement number, suffixed by an alphabetical symbol (A, B, C, D, etc.).

2.7. Coordination of IR Study Listings

The IRWSC is the primary means for coordinating IR studies among DoD activities and the GSA. Any justified exceptions to this coordination policy are addressed case by case with the affected service or agency.

2.7.1. Coordination Process

The IRA coordinates large studies of item name groupings or single-item studies in support of supply management using these procedures. When the number of items for review exceeds 200, the IRA may prepare listings tailored to each using military department and agency. No study contains more than 2,000 ISC 3 items. If the number of items is less than 200, the IRA furnishes the complete listing for each using military department and agency. The IRA must ensure the availability of a complete listing for the custodians in the IRWSC. In addition to the listing, the IRA provides reference information in the IRWSC or responds directly to inquiries about the following:

2.7.1.1. All available source data and drawings for replacement or replaced items, as well as proposed reason codes and technical data availability codes.

2.7.1.2. If available, and upon request, technical criteria.

2.7.1.3. Available cost and other non-technical data that may affect concurrence or non-concurrence with the ISC.

2.7.1.4. Recommendations for further standardization or documentation.

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2.7.2. Coordination Schedules

All PIRSLs available for review at the IRWSC indicate the time allowed for the initial response based on the following:

- For proposals containing 200 or less ISC 3 items—75 calendar days.
- For proposals containing 201 to 500 ISC 3 items—105 calendar days.
- For proposals containing 501 to 1,000 ISC 3 items—135 calendar days.
- For proposals containing more than 1,000 ISC 3 items—195 calendar days.
- Using activities requesting extensions must submit requests and justifications to the custodian. Custodians must request extensions from the IRA.

2.7.3. Study Distribution. All DoD users in the FLIS TIR and the GSA are notified by email of the availability of an IR study, either an expedited item reduction study listing (EIRSL) or PIRSL, for review at the IRWSC. The GSA distributes the proposed study to civilian users.

2.7.4. Using Activity Responsibility. The using activities review their items with respect to the ISC recommended by the IRA. The using activities must exhaust all available sources before requesting data from the IRA. When requesting data, the using activity must reference the data request by the index number of the items in the IR study. Data should not be required on standardization documents in the ASSIST database or FLIS TIR. Where the IRA's recommendation is not acceptable, the using activity sends its non-concurrence, item by item, supported with justification to the IRA through the custodian. These justifications must be related to specific elements of the I&S criteria from the performance of the study, e.g., source data, cost, or other non-technical data related to the NSN of the proposal.

2.7.5. Custodian Activity Responsibility. On receipt of an IR study listing from the IRA, the custodian reviews the distribution to using activities and, if additional distribution is required, so informs the IRA. On receipt of all the using activities' comments on the IR study, the custodian reviews the comments and resolves the intra-departmental or agency position. Custodians must submit supporting statements and recommendations to the IRA via the IRWSC. The IRWSC considers a custodian response of "Concur" or "No Interest" as a "Concur." The "No Interest" response reflects a need for file maintenance by review activities to remove their MOE rules from the subject NSN to exclude it from future IR efforts. Custodians must follow-up and ensure the appropriate actions are taken. The custodian should not submit partial replies to the IRA. However, to expedite the recording of acceptable standardization decisions into the FLIS, partial replies may be submitted with the understanding that the custodian has furnished a final departmental or agency position on each of the items in the partial reply. Custodians must send a complete reply in the time stated in paragraph 2.7.2., unless the IRA grants an extension.

2.7.6. Delinquent Replies. If all replies are not received by the original or revised coordination date, the IRA should contact the custodian to inquire about the reason for the delay and request an immediate response. The custodian has the responsibility of answering the IRA and should exercise whatever means necessary to provide that answer. The custodian must use judgment,

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all responses received, and outside sources of technical information, as necessary, to answer. A response from each using activity is not necessary for the custodian to respond if the custodian believes that an answer is not forthcoming from that activity. If the IRA does not get a response and does not believe one is forthcoming, the IRA should send the documented case to the Departmental Standardization Office (DepSO) of the delinquent custodian for resolution. The DepSO should take whatever action necessary with its counterparts to ensure replies within 30 days.

2.8. Expedited IR Study Listings

EIRSLs are studies with a limited number of items. All EIRSLs are available for review at the IRWSC. The IRA must issue these studies only to obtain coordination with the military departments, agencies, and the GSA to ensure logistics support essential to weapon system performance, operation, mission capability and readiness, or the preservation of life or safety of operating personnel and to prevent a no-stock situation. The service or agency sets the procedures and processes employed to manage the situation. These items should be given priority processing by the users. The following criteria applies:

2.8.1. No study contains more than 20 families with no more than 50 total items.

2.8.2. The completion time frame is the activation date plus 35 calendar days (activation date + 35 days = suspense or due date). The activation date is the date the study was activated or published at the IRWSC.

2.8.3. All items, ISC 1 and 3, must have all technical data available.

2.8.4. When non-concurrence is decided, the using activities must exhaust all avenues to provide alternative sources of supply before transmittal of the non-concurrence to the IRA.

2.8.5. The DLA Form 339 engineering support process may be used to expedite IR studies, especially those proposing a one-to-one relationship, comparable to an engineering support request, that would qualify for reimbursement based upon the Engineering Support Program in accordance with DoDI 4140.69, *Engineering Support Instructions for Items Supplied by Defense Logistics Agency (DLA)*.

2.8.6. The relationships, decided by the engineering support process, have ISC and associated I&S data sent to the DLIS by the activity generating the Form 339, to ensure documentation of order of use (OOU) and I&S in the FLIS.

2.9. Responding to Non-Concurrences

If the IRA accepts all non-concurrences, then a response is not necessary. If the non-concurrences are few, the IRA may call or email to advise custodians or using activities of the handling of their non-concurrences. For lengthy or complex non-concurrences, the IRA must respond with a letter or electronic transmittal or hold a resolution meeting.

2.10. Resolving Non-Concurrences

The IRA can resolve non-concurrences in one of three ways:

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2.10.1. The IRA may accept the non-concurrence.

2.10.2. The IRA may reject the non-concurrence with justification, allowing the submitter at least 30 working days to rebut the rejection. If no reply is received in 30 working days, the IRA should contact the custodian. Items are not standardized by default.

2.10.3. If the IRA is unable to resolve the non-concurrence promptly, it may ask the cognizant LSA to mediate. If the LSA cannot resolve the issue, the LSA can submit the unresolved non-concurrences to the IRA's DepSO for resolution and possible submission to the Defense Standardization Program Office (DSPO) for arbitration.

2.11. Summary of IR

The summary of IR documents the result of IR study's completed item reduction listing (CIRL). The summary is recorded in the IRWSC. The general organization of information for the summary follows:

2.11.1. **Summary Cover Sheet.** The summary cover sheet contains the following:

- Project number.
- FSC.
- Project title.
- Item names in study.
- IRA.
- LSA.
- Custodians.

2.11.2. **Executive Summary.** The executive summary briefly describes the cover sheet, for example, date of project initiation, project scope, working group membership, and meeting date, if applicable.

2.11.2.1. Reference. The reference briefly describes the cover sheet and notes the date.

2.11.2.2. Project Scope. The project scope briefly describes the intent of the IR effort and the items studied.

2.11.2.3. Coordination of the Study. The study coordination includes a statement indicating the degree of coordination accomplished with the other military and civilian agencies and a statement concerning the resolution of all essential comments or other statements, such as a list of non-concurrences.

2.11.2.4. Class Condition Observation. The class condition observation includes a general statement of the condition of the FSC or name grouping (from a supply viewpoint). This statement should include an evaluation of the IR potential or level reached, extent of documentation of items covered by specifications and standards, and recommendations for collecting data for items coded ISC C with a cost-effectiveness appraisal.

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2.11.2.5. Findings and Recommendations. The findings and recommendations includes the following under this heading:

2.11.2.5.1. The total number of items reviewed in the study.

2.11.2.5.2. The number of items designated as ISC 1.

2.11.2.5.3. The number of items designated as ISC 2.

2.11.2.5.4. The number of items designated as ISC C.

2.11.2.5.5. The number of items designated as ISC 3.

2.11.2.5.6. The number of duplicate items canceled.

2.11.2.5.7. The number of cataloging part number additions and corrections submitted.

2.11.2.5.8. The number of changes to item identification submitted. The number of cataloging descriptive corrections submitted.

2.11.2.5.10. The benefits resulting from the study, such as the number of cancel use actions, cancel duplicate actions, cancel invalid actions, reference type item identifications (IIs) converted to full descriptive type IIs, corrections made to type IIs, transfers due to resolving misclassifications, and, when possible, tangible dollar savings achieved.

2.11.2.5.11. After coordinating with the LSA and obtaining project numbers, recommendations for further standardization projects, including the study and document projects, the preparing activity, the proposed scope, the schedule, and the assigned project number.

2.11.2.6. Accomplishments. The accomplishments list intangible benefits that enhance the Federal Supply System.

2.12. Summary of Expedited IR Studies

The expedited summary uses the IRWSC summary of IR format and content discussed in subsection 2.11. to document the results of the expedited IR study. Within 45 days of the completed study, the custodians and using activities will receive email notification that the summary is available to view at the IRWSC. The LSA is provided with a copy of the CIRL.

2.13. Completion of an IR Study

On completion of the summary of IR, the IRA does the following:

2.13.1. Approve the IR project and close the ASSIST-Project.

2.13.2. Prepare a listing of all the items in the IR study that required a change in the ISC.

2.13.3. Follow the procedures of section 5 to document and disseminate the standardization decisions.

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2.13.4. Send the custodians and using activities email notification about the availability of a completed summary of IR for viewing at the IRWSC. The LSA is provided with a copy of the summary.

2.13.5. Provide the PICA with a copy of the summary of the IR study for coordination and follow-up of DoD interchangeability and substitutability, in accordance with the joint publication Air Force Materiel Command Instruction 20-101, Army Materiel Command Regulation 700-30, Naval Supply Systems Command 4410.57, Marine Corps Order 4410.24A, and Defense Logistics Agency Regulation 4140.66, *Elimination of Duplication in the Management and Logistics Support of Interchangeable and Substitutable Items,* www.marines.mil/Portals/1/Publications/MCO%204410.24A.pdf.

2.14. Project Record

The IRA maintains a record of the project with, as a minimum, the summary of IR and the listing of all of the items in the study that required a change in the ISC.

3. OTHER ITEM STANDARDIZATION ACTIONS

3.1.General

The procedures in this section apply to all the FSCs in Volume 10, Chapter 4, Table 93, of DoDM 4100.39, https://www.dla.mil/LogisticsOperations/TrainingandReference/FLISProcedures.asp, and all of Federal Supply (FSG) Group 59, except 5940, 5970, 5975, 5977, and 5995. This section describes the assignment of the ISCs during, or because of, the following actions:

3.1.1. New items processed through the DLIS for NSN assignment.

3.1.2. New or revised superseding specifications, standards, or CIDs for which the item in the new or revised specification, standard, or CID supersedes an existing item. An item in a new or revised superseding specification, standard, or CID may be assigned an NSN.

3.1.3. Those items in a specific FSC or item name grouping in that class classified as one-of-a-kind and, as a result, with no item reduction potential.

3.2. New Items Processed through the FLIS

New item requests are submitted to the FLIS in compliance with the cataloging item entry control procedures in DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687. New NSNs are assigned to ISC 5.

ISC 0 is assigned to NSA or DTRA items.

3.3. Superseding Specifications and Standards

When a new or revised superseding specification or standard is approved and cross-reference supersession data between the new items and replaced items is clearly stated, the new items and replaced items must have ISCs assigned. ISC B and E apply. When a specification or

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standard is superseded, the preparing activity of the superseding document notifies the IRA if item replacement actions are required. When this type of item replacement occurs, an NSN cannot be assigned to a new item until generation of a procurement or demand requirement for the item. During these replacement actions, ISC E must be assigned to any items replaced by items covered by the superseding document and ISC B must be assigned to the replacement items, regardless of registered users. However, the IRA must include superseded specification or standard items that fall in the following categories in an IR study and coordinate with the using activities, ISC 1/B and 3 apply: those with additional requirements over and above the specification or standard requirements or source-controlled items.

3.4. Federal Catalog System

Items of supply bought, stocked, or distributed in the federal supply systems are named, identified, classified, and numbered for inclusion in the FCS. Some specification items and materials do not conform to the regular stock-numbering criteria but are involved in daily supply operations. Some of these items have been subjected to standardization review and have no supply system requirement established but are authorized for acquisition. The standardization review classifies a standard item as the preferred item.

3.5. No IR Potential

The IRA must analyze each FSC or approved item name code before planning and programming an IR study project and make a cost-effectiveness determination. The IRA maintains a record of the analysis for each FSC or approved item name code declared to have no IR potential and a listing of all the items coded ISC 6. Item listings need not be maintained if the required data is accessible in machine format. The procedures of section 4 implement these standardization decisions. ISC 6 is used only for an FSC or an entire approved item name code. It must not be used on an individual item, unless the item is a new item belonging in an approved item name code already declared to have no IR potential. The use of ISC 6 should be closely scrutinized. Assignment of ISC 6 to an FSC or an approved item name code must not preclude future IR studies on the item.

4. INITIAL ACTIONS FOR RECORDING AND DISSEMINATING STANDARDIZATION DECISIONS

4.1. Actions by the IRA

The IRA does the following:

4.1.1. Forward, without delay, the following information to the FLIS: Standardization data submitted through the established transmission systems authorized by the FLIS. When the NSA, activity code XP/XN, is managing activity, CAGE code 98230 must be registered as part of the design control reference for the assignment of ISC 0 by the FLIS. When DTRA, activity code XA/XB, is the managing activity, CAGE code 57991, 67991, 77991, or 87991 must be registered as a part of the applicable design control reference number. When this data is not properly shown for the item, the IRA must contact the DTRA for correction of the records. This procedure does not modify the basic requirement for the use of ISC 0 by the DTRA.

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4.1.2. Submit data to the DLIS by electronic transmission or by letter of transmittal with the subject "Documentation of Standardization Decisions." The transmittal letter indicates the total number of NSNs in each ISC submitted for processing. A separate letter of transmittal must be prepared for each shipment of transmitted data to the DLIS.

4.2. Action by Activity Determining "No Potential"

The activity determining "No Potential" submits standardization data for items assigned ISC 6 to the FLIS, as outlined in subsection 4.1.

4.3. Action by Activity Implementing Item Replacement Due to Superseding Specifications or Standards

The activity implementing IR due to superseding specifications or standards submits standardization data for items assigned ISC B or E to the DLIS as outlined in subsection 4.1.

4.4. Actions by the DLIS

The DLIS does the following:

4.4.1. Receive standardization data from the submitting activity.

4.4.2. Process the standardization data received and enter the ISC, the originator of the decision, and the date of the decision assigned to the items by the submitting activity in the TIR, in accordance with DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687.

4.4.3. Forward information to authorized recipients of standardization data. See DoDM 4100.39, Volume 6, Chapter 5, https://www.dla.mil/HQ/LogisticsOperations/TrainingandReference/FLISProcedures.aspx. Forward logistics item data to the appropriate LSA or IRA, as requested. For each item not authorized for acquisition, the standardization relationship data record must reflect the replacement NSN.

4.4.4. Establish a cross-reference between items not authorized for acquisition, the replacement item, and the reverse relationships.

4.4.5. Assign ISC 5 or 0 as applicable to all new NSN requests, except those coded under procedures in subsection 3.3.

5. IMPLEMENTATION OF STANDARDIZATION DECISIONS BY THE MAJOR SUBORDINATE COMMAND, SYSTEM COMMAND, INTEGRATED MATERIEL MANAGER, AND CATALOGING COMPONENT

5.1. Action by the Major Subordinate Command (MSC), System Command (SysCom), and Integrated Material Manager (IMM)

Initial distribution of revised standardization data is furnished from the DLIS, in accordance with DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687. Upon receipt of the revised standardization

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relationship data with the ISCs assigned to the items, the MSC, SysCom, and IMM take appropriate action in accordance with the following:

5.1.1. Record the ISC of the item in all supply records, including catalog records, as applicable.

5.1.2. Advise the cataloging component of each change in the supply management status of the item, other than standardization codes, so appropriate action may be submitted to the FLIS.

5.1.3. Forward appeals to standardization decisions with justification or other requests for changes in ISCs to the appropriate IRA, custodian, or integrated manager. Copies are furnished to the LSA or IRA, as requested.

5.2. Action by the MSC, SysCom, and IMM Cataloging Component

The cataloging component does the following:

5.2.1. Prepare and submit, in accordance with normal cataloging procedures, appropriate data furnished by the managing activity under subsection 5.1. progressively for the FLIS.

5.2.1.1. When the stock of an item not authorized for acquisition is exhausted, a delete user action, in accordance with normal cataloging procedures, should be submitted for the item not authorized for acquisition. See DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687.

5.2.1.2. When the standardization decision involves the adoption of an NSN replacement item new to the managing activity's supply system, an add-user transaction should be submitted for the new item in the FLIS, in accordance with DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687.

5.2.1.3. For items under integrated management, the submissions covered by subparagraphs 5.2.1.1. and 5.2.1.2. are processed by the integrated manager. However, all item deletions require concurrence by the using activities before initiation of withdrawal actions by the integrated manager. Such action may be based on acceptance of IR proposals or specification supersessions.

5.2.1.4. When the consolidation or exhaustion of stocks for the obsolete item is complete, a delete user action should be submitted for the obsolete item in accordance with normal cataloging procedures.

5.2.2. Prepare and submit, in accordance with the normal DLIS and cataloging procedures, add-user transactions reflecting acquisition or reacquisition of items previously subjected to an IR study progressively in the FLIS.

6. IR MAINTENANCE ACTIONS

6.1. The IRA does the following:

6.1.1. Ensure standardization studies involving items in interchangeable and substitutable families consider, as a minimum, all the items in those families. Standardization decisions

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can supersede interchangeable and substitutable data assignments of items in family structures. However, interchangeable and substitutable data assignments must not contradict standardization coding assignments.

6.1.2. Review all justifications for acquisition and reacquisition of items not authorized for acquisition and advise the submitting activity of whether the ISC of the item changed. When appropriate, notify the DLIS of a change, in accordance with procedures in DoDM 4100.39, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodm/410039m.pdf?ver=2019-06-04-090814-687.

6.1.3. Review and forward appeals or other requests for changes in standardization coding, with recommendations, to the appropriate custodian for resolution. These changes affect only the relationship under consideration by the appeal. Mass ISC changes must not be made unless the criteria selection was in error.

6.1.4. Review those items not subjected to item standardization at intervals deemed necessary since the last review and propose and coordinate, as appropriate, the ISC for groups of such items.

6.1.5. Forward standardization data submitted through the established transmission process, when authorized by the DLIS.

6.2. The Integrated Manager does the following:

6.2.1. Restructure interchangeable and substitutable families to reflect standardization decisions.

6.2.2. Collaborate with the using military department or defense agency on all new or revised interchangeable and substitutable family structures before entering the interchangeable and substitutable families in the FLIS TIR, except for relationships coordinated through the IR study process.

6.3. The DLIS does the following:

6.3.1. Receive standardization data through the transmission process established with the submitting activity and take necessary action, in accordance with subsection 4.4. to enter the official ISC for new items and items that have changed status in the FLIS records.

6.3.2. Forward standardization data with the official ISC to authorized data recipients.

6.3.3. Receive and process catalog data for proposed add-MOE Rule or user transactions. When the add-MOE Rule transaction is submitted for an item not authorized for procurement (ISC 3 or E), process the add-MOE Rule or user transaction and record the activity as a user of the item identification. Furnish file data for the item not authorized for acquisition from the FLIS to the authorized data recipients. The originator is furnished file data for the replacement NSN, if TIR records a relationship.

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6.3.4. Process FSC changes by forwarding notification of the FSC changes and file data for the item under the new FSC to the receiving activities in accordance with cataloging procedures. If the FSC change is processed against an item recorded in a standardization relationship, the responsible military department or defense agency takes the necessary action in DoDM 4140.26, https://www.esd.whs.mil/Directives/issuances/dodm.

6.3.5. Forward a listing of new items not previously subjected to item standardization to the appropriate standardization management activities who are not on normal distribution.

7. MSC, SYSCOM, AND IMM ACTIONS ON ITEM STANDARDIZATION DECISIONS

7.1. MSC, SysCom, and IMM take the following actions on all line items subject to the procedures in sections 4 and 5.

7.1.1. Ensure that the manager of the NSN coded ISC 1 or B in a standardization relationship is also the manager of the member NSNs in the standardization relationship coded ISC 3 or E on the standardization relationship recorded in the FLIS.

7.1.2. Record standardization status on all supply records, including catalog records, as applicable.

7.1.3. Review supply records of items proposed for acquisition for conformance with ISC status.

7.1.4. Transmit, in accordance with Catalog Management Data Notification procedures, the appropriate phrase code, OOU, and acquisition advice code to define the item relationships and supply actions applicable following the assignment of ISCs 1 or B and 3 or E for set of items.

7.1.5. Establish procedures to encourage the use of items not authorized for acquisition until these are exhausted through OOU or manually offering items.

7.1.6. Review due-in assets' positions and terminate contracts, as feasible, when the total assets of items authorized for acquisition and items not authorized for acquisition on-hand and on-order exceed authorized levels.

7.1.7. Review due outs and offer substitute items, as appropriate, to reduce stocks of items not authorized for acquisition.

7.1.8. Restrict purchase authority while reducing items not authorized for acquisition by attrition and for items eliminated from the supply system to prevent acquisition of additional items when replacements are available.

7.1.9. Review terminal stocked items, ISC 3, or ISC E with an on-hand wholesale asset position and a coordinated replacement for elimination from the system based on cost effectiveness. The PICA should evaluate the item based on the value of assets on-hand in relation to the

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predicted time over which item attrition would take place. Generally, when the item for elimination has an extensive issue-to-exhaustion time, coupled with a low dollar value of assets, the PICA must coordinate a proposed delete action with all the registered users. Assets should be retained and issued when the demand forecast indicates that assets can be issued in a relatively short period of time regardless of the dollar value of assets.

7.1.10. Ensure that future acquisition for wholesale stockage is limited to items authorized for acquisition.

7.1.11. On an interim basis, items coded as ISC 3 or E may be acquired for direct delivery to any requisitioning activity that has challenged the standardization coding.The requisitioning activity must forward justification and conditions for ISC changes to the appropriate customer account specialist. The following information must be furnished:

- Specific end-use and end-item application.
- Technical explanation comparing the physical and functional characteristics of the ISC 3 or E item with the item authorized for acquisition.
- Duration of the requirement for the item or how long the end-item will be retained.
- Economic considerations from a technical standpoint.

The customer account specialist must forward the justification to the IRA responsible for the standardization decision for review and to the appropriate custodian for resolution before rendering an appeal decision.

7.1.12. When the GSA supplies central management purchase support through its stores, direct delivery requisition contracts, Federal Supply Schedules, or mandatory consolidated purchasing programs, all activities must adhere to the requirements of approved standardization decisions. DoD activities shall not use decentralization to avoid using an item authorized for acquisition and furnished through GSA acquisition operations.

8. RECOMMENDED METRICS

The collection of the following IR study metrics annually by IRAs is recommended:

- The number of IR studies initiated
  - Routine
  - Expedited
- The number of IR studies received
- The number of IR studies completed
  - Response of coordinating activities
  - All responses received from initiating activities
- The number of NSNs reviewed
- The number of ISC changes approved
- The number of cancel use, cancel duplicate, and cancel invalid actions
- The number of items converted from a reference type II (type 2) to a full descriptive type II (type 1, 1A, or 1B)
- The numbers of items for which II is corrected or the item is transferred to correct a II misclassification
- Hours expended on IR studies.

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Appendix A. Acronyms

Abbreviations	Full Name
CAGE	Commercial and Government Entity
CID	Commercial item description
CIRL	Completed item reduction listing
DepSO	Departmental Standardization Office
DLA	Defense Logistics Agency
DLIS	DLA Logistics Information Services
DoD	Department of Defense
DSPO	Defense Standardization Program Office
DTRA	Defense Threat Reduction Agency
EIRSL	Expedited item reduction study list
FCS	Federal Catalog System
FLIS	Federal Logistics Information System
FSC	Federal supply classification
GSA	General Services Administration
I&S	Interchangeability and substitutability
II	Item identification
IIG	Item Identification Guide
IMM	Integrated materiel manager
IR	Item reduction
IRA	Item reduction activity
IRWSC	Item Reduction Website Capability
ISC	Item standardization code
LSA	Lead standardization activity
MOE	Major organizational entity
MSC	Major subordinate command
NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Organization
NAVSEA	Naval Sea Systems Command
NGS	Non-government standard
NSA	National Security Agency
NSN	National stock number
OOU	Order of use
PICA	Primary inventory control activity
PIRSL	Proposed item reduction study listing
SICA	Secondary inventory control activity
SysCom	System command
TIR	Total item record

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Appendix B. Definitions

INTERCHANGEABILITY AND SUBSTITUTABILITY

Conditions that permit the exchange of one item for another without affecting design or performance beyond acceptable limits. (DoDM 4100.39)

ITEM IDENTIFICATION TYPE 2

An item identified solely by the following:

- Name (approved item name or part name)
- CAGE.
- Reference number related to the item.

ITEM REDUCTION ACTIVITY

An organization in a military department, defense agency, or civilian agency responsible for reviewing FSCs or item name codes for reducing, to the highest degree practicable, the number of sizes and kinds of generally similar items. (DoDM 4120.24)

ITEM REDUCTION STUDY

An analysis to uncover unneeded items in the supply system, involving a technical review of supply items to find duplicate or overlapping items and reduce in the number of similar items. (DoDM 4120.24)

ITEM REDUCTION WEBSITE CAPABILITY SYSTEM

The system for electronically initiating and coordinating IR studies. The IRWSC is maintained by DLA Land & Maritime.

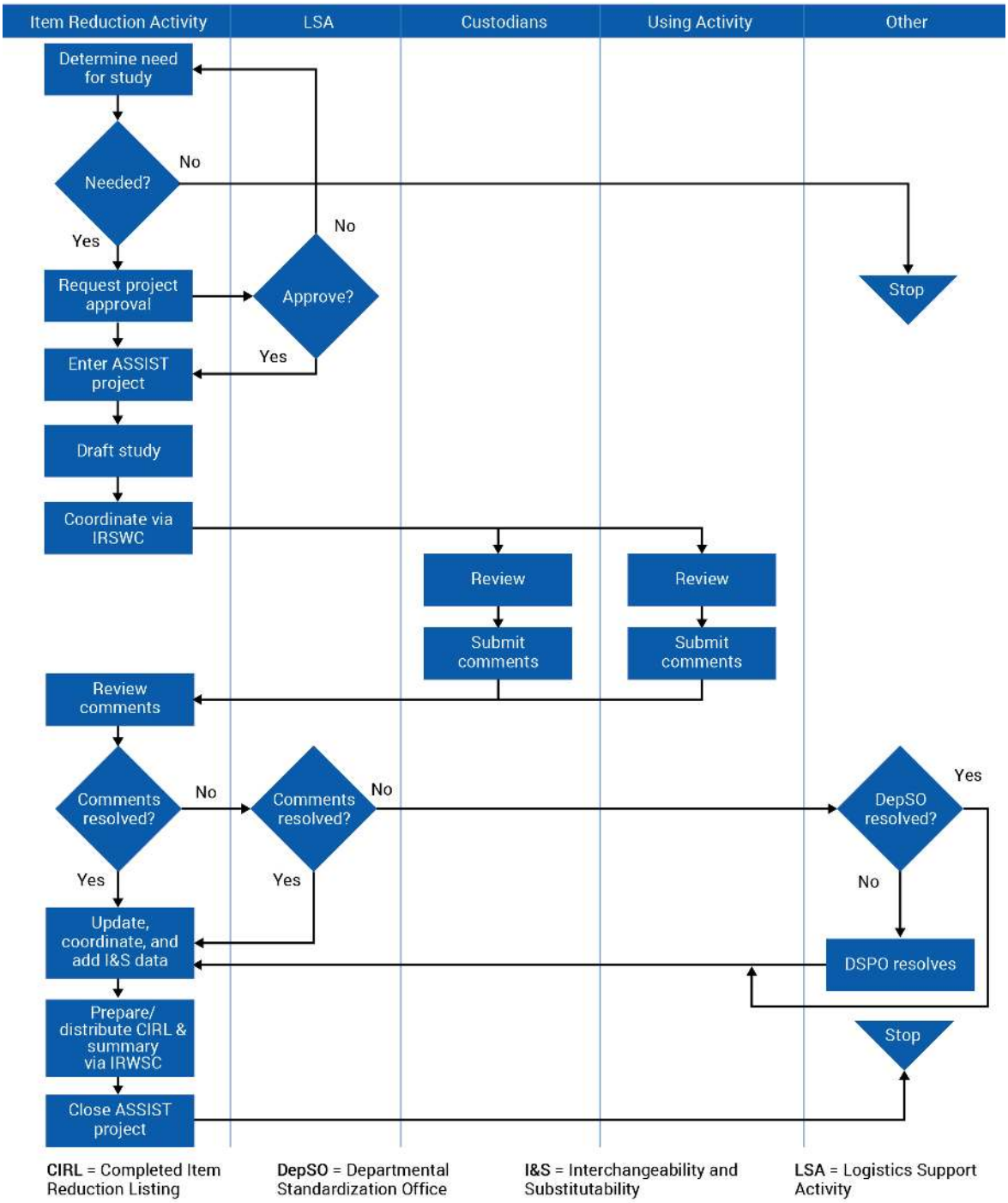
ITEM STANDARDIZATION CODE

A code assigned to an item in the supply system that categorizes the item as authorized for procurement or not authorized for procurement. (41 CFR Sec.101-30.701-2)

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Appendix C. The IR Study Process

Figure 1. The IR study process using the IRWSC



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Appendix D. Item Reduction Website Capability Documentation Information Guide

The IRWSC Documentation Information Guide is maintained by DLA at https://www.dsp.dla.mil/Programs/Item-Reduction/. To request access to the IRWSC, contact DLA at dscc.itemreduction@dla.mil.

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